

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8b-1jvk-dg8q
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-7840

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

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General Comment

Generative AI is problematic because it pulls on the creative work of millions of people without their knowledge or consent, and never compensates them for their work. The people who make Generative AI also say that it is always hungry, demanding more and more resources: content to place into the data bank, and physical resources to keep it powered.

It is in the end theft, not only of the creative work and effort of people, but of thought as well.

By relying so heavily on generative AI, the American people will cease to think on their own, and lack critical thinking skills. By making generative AI prolific, the American people can easily be manipulated by other powers by feeding misinformation into the data pool, which will be regurgitated by an uncaring machine that they believe have the answers.

Stop generative AI. It is a poison that is killing us all.

Attachments

Letter about Gen AI

From:
Artist/Psychology Graduate

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

I am an everyday American who illustrates characters and creates logos for clients. I have worked hard for years to develop the skills and knowledge to build my business, and have been lucky enough to be a part of multiple creative communities, many of which cater to minority groups like LGBTQ+, those who are neurodivergent, and those with learning disabilities. Because of these communities I have made long friendships, helped others overcome social anxiety, and was honored to teach others valuable skills and experiences they will cherish for years to come.

The AI systems made by Big Tech companies like OpenAI (Microsoft) and Google threaten to destroy thousands of American small businesses like mine with their recent demand to create special carve outs in copyright law.

AI systems can only be produced by first training on work made by people. My unique work, and the work of hundreds of thousands of other everyday American creators was taken and fed into these AI systems without our consent or any compensation. They ingest our work, reassemble it, and then sell it back to our clients – directly competing with us and cutting us out of the marketplace.

Now these Big Tech companies are asking this administration to create exceptions and loopholes to make this practice of stealing American creators' copyrighted work legal precedent. They are suggesting that if a machine ingests and reproduces copyrighted work, it is somehow suddenly "fair use".

They seem to believe that anything and everything on the internet – regardless of who owns it – should be theirs for the taking. They claim that if this administration does not allow them to rewrite the law in this way, it will stifle American innovation.

Instead, it will have the opposite effect. The purpose of American copyright law is to protect the incentive to create and innovate.

If we the American people do not own our creations, and everything we put online will be stolen by Big Tech giants, what will be the incentive to create? If everyday Americans create a new innovative piece of computer code, a new visual design, or a new piece of music only to have it immediately stolen by

Google and Microsoft, why bother creating it in the first place? How will we possibly make a living doing these things?

When everything is stolen, nothing will be original, and there will be no incentive to move forward with other technology in the future. **Generative AI will kill American thought, creativity, individuality, and critical thinking.**

Want to protect American innovation? Protect American creators. **Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and everyday Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.**

This administration's AI Action Plan should focus not on giving away creator content to Big Tech companies, but rather on ensuring a fair marketplace with competition:

- First, the government should ensure that creators and everyday Americans give effective **consent**, so that we can decide when and where our work is used by AI systems.
- Second, the AI Action Plan should encourage a robust **licensing** marketplace, so that the incentive to create for small businesses is preserved. Our work has immense economic value, so the value generated by that work should accrue to the original creators, not just Big Tech.
- Finally, the AI Action Plan should require **transparency** from Big Tech companies, requiring them to disclose what material is in their training datasets, and label what content is AI generated.

I am not anti-technology or anti-AI. I am consistently impressed by the capabilities of these AI systems, and find them incredibly useful for many things. In fact, I still believe that if Generative AI can be made ethically, fairly, and with consent, it can be a huge boon in the future. But we should not sacrifice the hard work of hundreds of millions of Americans and give it away to Big Tech by rewriting copyright law.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on these important issues.